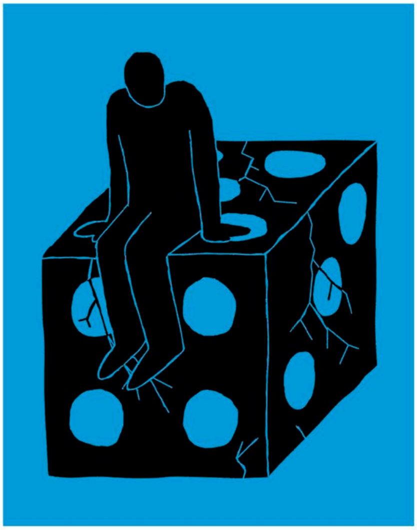

ALL CONTRACTS BY WAY OF GAMING SHALL BE NULL AND VOID

THE GAMING ACT (1845)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS
Gambling regulation

BEFORE
1254 King Louis IX bans gambling in France, in the first of many such edicts.

1541 In England, the Unlawful Games Act outlaws pastimes deemed distracting to the public, such as dicing tables, card tables, bowls, and tennis.

AFTER
1853 The Betting Act makes it illegal to use any premises for betting in the UK.

1910 The state of Nevada is one of the last in the US to ban casino gambling.

1931 The first casino opens in Las Vegas after the Nevada authorities legalize gambling due to its economic benefits.

2005 The UK Gambling Act makes wagers legally enforceable, ushering in an era of liberalized gambling.

Gaming and betting **grow in popularity** in the 18th century.

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Increasing numbers of **legal cases** are brought to **recover gambling debts**.

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The 1845 Gaming Act makes gaming contracts null and void.

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Gambling debts are **no longer legally recoverable** in the courts.

Gaming (playing games of chance, such as dice) and wagering (placing a bet on an expected outcome) have long presented a dilemma to legislators. Often decried as a moral scourge by politicians and religious leaders, gambling has been variously prohibited—due to the financial ruin and negative social effects it often brings—or legalized in order to regulate it, protect participants, and tax it to boost state funds.

Although certain new games were, in theory, outlawed in 1541 in England, with the aim of preventing the public from neglecting their archery practice, the prohibition was